



Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Today in health news.



Learning Outcome

Describe the reasons or results of events or actions in spoken or written texts, in work and social contexts.

Ask your partner:

- What health-related news stories have you heard recently?
- Do you think owning a pet can make a person healthier? Why or why not?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about health and wellness.
- I can talk about what has happened.
- I can talk about the reason of an action or an event.

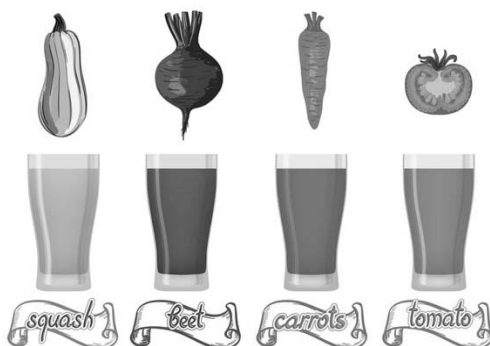




Let's Explore!

This just in*!

* "This just in" is a common phrase used by newscasters presenting new information.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Good evening, and welcome to the Fit Fifty, where we bring you fifty minutes of fitness news.

In our top story tonight, a study has revealed that children who own pets have less stress. The research, which has included children from Australia to the UK, outlines the numerous benefits to pet ownership. First and foremost, pets encourage physical activity. Most of our viewers will not find this surprising, inasmuch as dogs require daily walks. Pets also act as a kind of live-in therapist, in that they provide comfort and increase self-esteem. Last but not least, our furry companions can help to reduce stress and anxiety, as they stimulate interaction and conversation.

Moving to the kitchen, a new study has shown that drinking beetroot juice reduces high blood pressure. The landmark study, which was headed by a pharmacologist from Queen Mary University, focused on patients with hypertension. One group of patients was given a daily glass of beetroot juice, while the control group was given a placebo. The results have clearly demonstrated that a significant reduction in blood pressure can result from just one glass of the juice per day. The effect is caused by inorganic nitrate, which is contained in beetroot and other leafy vegetables, and which causes blood vessels to relax and dilate. The results are excellent insofar as they suggest that a reduction in blood pressure is possible; however, for most hypertension sufferers, a complete change in diet will also be necessary. Our last story of the day involves another common beverage: water. For obvious reasons, water is an important part of a healthy lifestyle. Most people have slowly begun to realize this fact, and have increased daily water intake. Recent findings, however, suggest that many people may need to up their consumption even further. According to the Institute of Medicine, the suggested daily intake of water for men is three liters.

That's all for this edition of the Fit Fifty. Remember folks, stay fit and have fun!



Let's Practice!

Do you have any habit that makes you feel healthier?

Instructions: Complete the sentences by choosing from the options that you are given. Read the complete sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

1.	2.	3.	4.	5.
blood vessels	placebo	self-esteem	hypertension	placebo
self-skin	hypertension	hypertension	blood vessels	blood vessels
self-esteem	interaction	interaction	placebo	interaction

- Pets also act as a kind of live-in therapist because they provide comfort and increase _____.
- Last but not least, our furry companions can help to reduce stress and anxiety, as they stimulate _____ and conversation.
- The landmark study focused on patients with _____.
- One group of patients was given a daily glass of beetroot juice, while the control group was given a _____.
- The effect is caused by inorganic nitrate, which is contained in beetroot and other leafy vegetables, and which causes _____ to relax and dilate.



Let's Practice!

Everything happens for a reason.

Instructions: Match the halves in Column A with the halves in Column B to complete the sentences correctly.

COLUMN A

- Most of our viewers will not find this surprising, inasmuch
- Pets also act as a kind of live-in therapist,
- The results are excellent insofar as
- For obvious reasons, water

COLUMN B

- they suggest that a reduction in blood pressure is possible.
- as dogs require daily walks.
- in that they provide comfort and self-esteem.
- is an important part of a healthy lifestyle.





Extension Activity

Report three health stories.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Go online and find three recent health-related stories.
- Make notes on the stories.
- Pretend that you are a newscaster, and present the three stories to your classmates.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I research health-related news.

☐ ☐

I make notes on health-related news.

☐ ☐

I present my notes to my classmates.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **therapist** (noun): a person who treats psychological problems
e.g. Pets also act as a kind of live-in therapist.
- **self-esteem** (noun): confidence in one's own abilities
e.g. Pets provide comfort and increase self-esteem.
- **pharmacologist** (noun): a person who studies the effects of drugs on the body
e.g. The landmark study, which was headed by a pharmacologist from Queen Mary University, focused on patients with hypertension.
- **hypertension** (noun): a medical condition in which a person's blood pressure is very high
e.g. Because he suffered from hypertension, he had to alter his diet.
- **placebo** (noun): a medicine that has no effect which is given to patients as a control when testing new drugs
e.g. One group of patients was given a daily glass of beetroot juice, while the control group was given a placebo.
- **blood vessel** (noun): a tube in the body through which blood flows
e.g. The effect is caused by inorganic nitrate, which is contained in beetroot and other leafy vegetables, and which causes blood vessels to relax and dilate.
- **to dilate** (verb): to become wider or more open
e.g. Once the blood vessels dilate, blood pressure decreases.





Learning Points

Present Perfect: Announcing News

You use the Present Perfect tense to announce past events that have current relevance.

When announcing news, the Present Perfect is used to focus on the new information.

Examples:

They have updated their website. (The website update is new information.)

They have just had a baby. (They are just now telling people the news.)

They have just called an election. (We did not expect this to happen.)

When using the Present Perfect Simple to talk about habitual actions or with state verbs, you often use a time marker such as *for* or *since*. *For* is used to introduce the period of time the action has happened. *Since* is used to mark the point in time when the action started.

Example:

The fire has burned for hours!

This has been the worst year for fires since 2014.

Examples:

- *In our top story tonight, a study has revealed that children who own pets have less stress.*
- *The research, which has included children from Australia to the UK, outlines the numerous benefits to pet ownership.*
- *Moving to the kitchen, a new study has shown that drinking beetroot juice reduces high blood pressure.*
- *The results have clearly demonstrated that a significant reduction in blood pressure can result from just one glass of the juice per day.*
- *Most people have slowly begun to realize this fact, and have increased daily water intake.*





Learning Points

Giving Reasons: *For, In that, Insofar as, Inasmuch as*

You use reason clauses to express the reasons for an action, or why a situation is the way it is.

You use words like *for, in that, insofar as, or inasmuch as* to introduce a reason clause to give a reason for something.

Reason clauses are subordinate to the main clause. They state the reason why things are done, or what makes a situation the way it is.

You can use *for, in that, insofar as, or inasmuch as* to introduce a reason clause to give a reason for something.

For has a meaning similar to *because* in a reason clause.

Example:

*We must begin planning, **for** the future may have some unexpected turns.*

In that, insofar as, inasmuch as, have similar meanings. You generally use these in formal written English rather than in spoken English. They introduce clauses that clarify what has been said by adding more detail and information.

Example:

*The film is unusual **in that** it only features 2 actors.*

Examples:

- *Most of our viewers will not find this surprising, inasmuch as dogs require daily walks.*
- *Pets also act as a kind of live-in therapist, in that they provide comfort and self-esteem.*
- *The results are excellent insofar as they suggest that a reduction in blood pressure is possible; however, for most hypertension sufferers, a complete change in diet will also be necessary.*
- *For obvious reasons, water is an important part of a healthy lifestyle.*

